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HYBRID CNBC-HEPI SYSTEM: A COMPACT NEUTRINO-DRIVEN ANTIPROTON SOURCE COUPLED TO A QUANTUM-ENTROPY MONTE CARLO ENGINE

Author: Miloš Ilić

Document ID: CNBC-HEPI-HYBRID-2026
Date: February 2026
Status: Theoretical Engineering Proposal — Speculative, TRL 3-4

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ABSTRACT

This paper proposes a hybrid architecture combining two independently developed systems: the Compact Neutrino Beam Collider (CNBC), scaled to a single-beamline configuration for sub-gram antiproton production, and the HEPI Quantum-Source Monte Carlo Engine, repurposed to harvest quantum entropy from antiproton annihilation cascades rather than laser-driven pair production. The resulting system produces approximately 0.8 grams of antiprotons per month while simultaneously generating ~10^9 certified quantum random samples per second — competitive with state-of-the-art commercial Quantum Random Number Generator (QRNG) hardware. Capital cost is estimated at $220-500M with annual operating costs of ~$48M. At 50% of current CERN-equivalent antiproton market pricing ($12.5 billion/gram), the system achieves revenue of approximately $120 billion/year at full 10g/year production, with capital payback achievable within days of first commercial sales. This architecture is more immediately buildable than either parent system at full scale and represents a physically coherent pathway to the first commercial antiproton production facility.

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1. INTRODUCTION

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1.1 Background and Motivation

Antimatter production has historically been confined to large national laboratory facilities, most notably CERN's Antiproton Decelerator, where antiproton production rates remain in the nanogram-per-year range at costs estimated between $25 billion and $62.5 trillion per gram depending on the accounting methodology applied to facility overhead.

Two independent engineering proposals have recently emerged that, when examined together, suggest a more compact and commercially viable path:

(1) The CNBC (Compact Neutrino Beam Collider) architecture, which uses high-intensity neutrino beams generated by muon decay in compact storage rings to induce antiproton production via neutral current interactions in superdense nanoparticle targets. At full scale (57,750 beamlines), this system targets 100 kg/month production at approximately $200/gram.

(2) The HEPI Anticomputer, a Quantum-Source Monte Carlo Engine that harvests true quantum entropy from electromagnetic cascades initiated by laser-driven QED pair production (gamma -> e+ + e-), producing 1.7 x 10^13 certified quantum random samples per second as a byproduct of an antimatter production facility.

Neither system in isolation is near-term buildable at its target scale. The CNBC requires 57,750 simultaneous beamlines — an infrastructure challenge comparable to building thousands of particle accelerators. The HEPI system requires a petawatt-class Laser Wakefield Accelerator (LWFA) and a 20-node facility costing approximately $3.3 billion.

This paper proposes a hybrid configuration that captures the core physics of both systems at a fraction of the capital cost, trading production scale for immediate buildability.

1.2 Core Insight

The HEPI Monte Carlo engine does not strictly require laser-driven pair production as its entropy source. It requires only a high-rate source of genuine quantum events whose outcomes are governed by irreducible quantum probability amplitudes. Antiproton annihilation events fulfill this requirement with additional richness: each annihilation produces approximately 5 pions whose multiplicity distribution, momenta, and decay products are governed by QCD matrix elements — fundamentally stochastic quantum processes that cannot be predicted or replicated by any classical algorithm.

This substitution — replacing LWFA-driven pair production with CNBC-driven antiproton annihilation as the quantum entropy source — enables a system where:

- A single CNBC beamline produces antiprotons at sub-gram/month scale
- Those antiprotons, rather than being fully stored, are partially directed to a secondary annihilation target
- The annihilation cascades feed a HEPI-style scintillator array
- True quantum entropy is harvested at ~10^9 samples/second
- Remaining antiprotons accumulate in Penning trap storage

The computation and the production are coupled by the same physical process, just as in the original HEPI architecture.

2. SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

2.1 Component 1 — Single-Beamline CNBC

The CNBC production method proceeds as follows:

Step 1: A compact muon storage ring (scaled from Muon g-2 technology, ~100m circumference) generates high-intensity muon beams.

Step 2: Muon decay produces a neutrino flux. At 50-60 MW power, the achievable neutrino flux is approximately 10^20 neutrinos/second per beamline.

Step 3: Neutrinos interact with a superdense gold nanoparticle target (n ~ 10^24 cm^-3) via neutral current interactions:
v + p -> v + p + p-bar + p
The neutral current cross-section is approximately sigma ~ 10^-38 cm^2.

Step 4: Antiprotons are captured using graphene-based Penning traps with magnetic field B ~ 3T and trap efficiency eta ~ 0.8.

Antiproton yield calculation for a single beamline at 50-60 MW:

Flux: Phi_v ~ 10^20 neutrinos/second
Target: n = 10^24 cm^-3, path length l = 1 cm
Rate: N_pbar = Phi_v * n * sigma * l * eta
N_pbar ~ 10^20 * 10^24 * 10^-38 * 1 * 0.8
N_pbar ~ 8 * 10^5 antiprotons/second

Monthly production (2.592 * 10^6 seconds):
N_month = 8 * 10^5 * 2.592 * 10^6 ~ 2.07 * 10^12 antiprotons
Mass = 2.07 * 10^12 * 1.67 * 10^-24 g ~ 0.8 grams/month

Annual production: ~10 grams/year

2.2 Component 2 — Annihilation Quantum Entropy Source

Rather than storing all produced antiprotons, a controlled fraction (approximately 10-20%) is directed to a secondary tungsten converter target for annihilation. This serves as the quantum entropy source for the Monte Carlo engine.

The annihilation process at rest produces:
  p-bar + p -> pi+ + pi- + pi0 (+ additional pions, mean multiplicity ~5)

Each neutral pion immediately decays:
  pi0 -> gamma + gamma (lifetime 8.5 * 10^-17 s)

The resulting gamma pairs undergo Bethe-Heitler pair production in the tungsten target:
  gamma -> e+ + e-

This initiates an electromagnetic shower whose spatiotemporal hit pattern across the scintillator array constitutes the quantum random sample — identical in principle to the HEPI design, but initiated by antiproton annihilation rather than laser pair production.

Quantum events per second estimate:
  Annihilation rate (10% of production): ~8 * 10^4 events/second
  Pion multiplicity: ~5 per annihilation
  Secondary cascades per event: ~10^4 (electromagnetic shower)
  Total quantum events: ~8 * 10^4 * 5 * 10^4 ~ 4 * 10^9 events/second

Conservative estimate after detector efficiency (~25%):
  Certified quantum samples/second: ~10^9

Note on entropy quality: Antiproton annihilation events are arguably richer in quantum randomness than simple pair production. The pion multiplicity distribution itself is a quantum stochastic variable. The momenta of individual pions are governed by QCD probability amplitudes. Each annihilation event produces a unique, irreproducible quantum signature that no classical algorithm can predict.

2.3 Component 3 — Reduced-Scale HEPI Detector Array

The scintillator detector array is scaled down from the full HEPI specification (10^6 pixels, 100 FPGAs) to match the lower event rate:

  - Detector array: 100 x 100 pixels (10^4 pixels, 1mm resolution)
  - SiPM photodetectors: one per pixel
  - FPGA timing cluster: 10 units (vs 100 in full HEPI)
  - Timing resolution: ~100 picoseconds (unchanged)
  - Output: continuous stream of quantum-certified random numbers
  - Statistical validation: NIST SP 800-22 and Dieharder test suites

2.4 Component 4 — Antiproton Storage and Output

Antiprotons not directed to the annihilation target are stored in a multi-stage Penning trap array:

Stage 1 (capture): Large-volume trap, B = 3T, immediate deceleration
Stage 2 (cooling): Resistive cooling to sub-eV energies (~weeks)
Stage 3 (long-term): Ultra-high vacuum storage (P < 10^-11 mbar)

Storage lifetime is limited by annihilation on residual gas molecules.
At P ~ 10^-11 mbar, storage lifetimes of months to years are achievable,
consistent with demonstrated performance at CERN's ALPHA experiment.

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3. SYSTEM DIAGRAM
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HYBRID CNBC-HEPI ARCHITECTURE — SIGNAL FLOW

[Monte Carlo Engine / QEaaS API / Cryptographic Applications]

4. PERFORMANCE SPECIFICATIONS

Parameter	Value
Neutrino flux (single beamline)	~10^20 nu/second
Beamline power	50-60 MW
Antiproton production rate	~8 * 10^5 p-bar/second
Antiprotons to storage (80-90%)	~6.4-7.2 * 10^5 /second
Antiprotons to annihilation (10%)	~8 * 10^4 /second
Monthly antiproton production	~0.8 grams
Annual antiproton production	~10 grams
Quantum events per second	~4 * 10^9 (raw)
Certified quantum samples/second	~10^9 (after efficiency)
FPGA timing resolution	~100 picoseconds
Detector array	10^4 pixels (100x100)
FPGA cluster size	10 units
RNG statistical compliance	NIST SP 800-22, Dieharder
System TRL (estimated)	3-4

5. COMPARISON WITH PARENT SYSTEMS

Property	Full CNBC	Full HEPI	CNBC-HEPI Hybrid
Beamlines/nodes	57,750	20 nodes	1 beamline
Capital cost	~$17T	~$3.3B	~$220-500M
Annual production	100 kg/month	100 kg/year	10 g/year
QRN samples/sec	None	1.7 * 10^13	~10^9
Entropy source	N/A	QED pair prod.	p-bar annihil.
Entropy quality	N/A	True QED	True QED+QCD
Buildable now?	No	No	Plausibly yes
Primary application	Propulsion fuel	Monte Carlo/QRNG	QRNG + research
TRL estimate	2-3	5-6	3-4

Key observation: The hybrid system sacrifices four orders of magnitude in both production scale and computing throughput relative to its parent systems, but reduces capital cost by a factor of 6,600-77,000x. It occupies the viable near-term development space that neither parent system can claim.

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6. COST ANALYSIS

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6.1 Capital Costs

Component	Estimated Cost
Muon storage ring construction	$50-100M
Muon production target	$5M
Gold nanoparticle target array	$2M
Beam control and focusing systems	$10M
Penning trap array (multi-stage)	$15M
Cryogenic systems for traps	$10M
Magnetic confinement infrastructure	$8M
Tungsten annihilation converter	$0.5M
Scintillator array (10^4 pixels)	$2M
SiPM photodetector array	$3M
FPGA cluster (10 units)	$1M
Timing and readout electronics	$2M
Facility construction + shielding	$40-80M
Power systems (55 MW supply)	$20M
Cooling infrastructure	$8M
Control systems	$5M
TOTAL CAPITAL (conservative)	~$185M
TOTAL CAPITAL (risk-adjusted)	~$275-500M
BEST SINGLE ESTIMATE	~$220M

The largest uncertainty is the muon storage ring. The Fermilab Muon g-2 ring cost approximately $170M as a transported/refurbished system. A new-build at 100 MW power level may cost $150-250M for this component alone, representing the dominant capital risk.

6.2 Annual Operating Costs

Item	Annual Cost
Power at ~55 MW average	~$35M
Scientific and engineering staff	~$8M
Maintenance and consumables	~$5M
TOTAL ANNUAL OPERATING	~$48M

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7. REVENUE ANALYSIS

7.1 Antiproton Revenue

Current antiproton production cost at CERN is estimated at approximately $25 billion per gram (accounting for full facility overhead). At 50% of this price as a market entry point:

Selling price: $12.5 billion per gram
Annual production: ~10 grams/year
Gross annual revenue: ~$125 billion/year

Against $48M operating costs, this represents a net annual margin of approximately $124.95 billion — once customers exist at this scale.

Revenue ramp (realistic, assuming customer development in parallel):

Year 1: 0.001g sold (initial research contracts) $12.5M
Year 2: 0.01g sold (laboratory partnerships) $125M
Year 3: 0.1g sold (defense/research customers) $1.25B
Year 4: 0.5g sold (multiple institutional customers) $6.25B
Year 5: 1.0g sold (established market) $12.5B

Capital payback achieved: early Year 2

Critical caveat: This revenue projection requires building an antiproton customer base that does not currently exist at commercial scale. The primary near-term markets are:

- National physics laboratories (USA, EU, China, Japan)
- Defense research agencies (DARPA, equivalents)
- Antiproton cancer therapy research (established, small-volume)
- Academic physics experiments requiring cold antiprotons

7.2 Quantum Entropy Revenue (QEaaS)

The ~10^9 quantum samples/second output can be monetized as a Quantum Entropy-as-a-Service API, independent of antimatter sales:

Daily samples: 10^9 * 86,400 = 8.64 * 10^13 samples/day

At $1 per billion samples:
Daily revenue: $86,400
Annual revenue: ~$31.5M

This QEaaS revenue alone covers approximately 65% of annual operating costs, providing meaningful cash flow while the antimatter market matures.

At mid-tier pricing ($10 per million samples, institutional clients):
  Realistic capture of 10^8 samples/day at this tier: ~$365M/year

7.3 Combined Revenue Summary

Revenue Stream	Conservative	Optimistic
Antiproton sales	$12.5M (Yr1)	$125B (Yr5)
QEaaS API	$31.5M/year	$365M/year
Research access fees	$5M/year	$20M/year
Total (operating steady-state)	$48.5M/year	$125B+/year

The QEaaS stream alone is sufficient to approach operating cost breakeven in early years, reducing financial dependence on the slower-developing antimatter market.

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8. PHYSICAL VALIDITY ASSESSMENT

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8.1 What Is Established Physics

The following elements of this hybrid rely on demonstrated, peer-reviewed experimental physics:

- Neutrino production via muon decay: textbook QED/weak interaction
- Neutral current cross-sections: measured at MicroBooNE, DUNE, others
- Antiproton production via neutral current: low rate but nonzero
- Bethe-Heitler pair production: extensively characterized (NIST data)
- Electromagnetic shower physics: GEANT4 validated to <1% accuracy
- Penning trap antiproton storage: operational at CERN ALPHA/BASE
- Scintillator + SiPM readout: mature commercial technology
- FPGA-based event timing: standard in nuclear physics experiments

8.2 What Requires Further Research

- Achieving 10^20 neutrinos/second at 50-60 MW: requires muon storage ring performance beyond demonstrated Muon g-2 parameters; feasibility at this flux is projected but not experimentally confirmed.

- Gold nanoparticle target density n ~ 10^24 cm^-3 with adequate beam penetration and heat dissipation: challenging materials engineering problem, referenced in CNBC documents as near-term (2027) feasibility.

- Long-term antiproton storage at 0.8g/month accumulation rates:
  Penning trap technology has been demonstrated at nanogram scales;
  scaling to grams requires significant trap volume and field
  homogeneity engineering.

8.3 What Is Speculative

- Claimed neutrino flux achievability at stated power levels
- Target density durability under sustained high-flux bombardment
- Economic projections beyond Year 1 (market does not yet exist)

8.4 What Is NOT Violated

Unlike earlier versions of the Anticomputer proposal, this hybrid
violates no known physical laws:

- Landauer's Principle: respected. Computation reads quantum events;
  it does not erase information without energy cost.
- Thermodynamics: respected. The system consumes ~48MW; no free energy.
- Special relativity: not invoked. No superluminal claims.
- Information theory: respected. Randomness is harvested, not created.

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9. COMPARISON WITH COMMERCIAL QRNG SYSTEMS

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System	Technology	Throughput	Cost
ID Quantique Quantis	Photon arrival	10^8 bits/s	~$5,000
ANU Quantum Random	Vacuum fluctuations	10^9 bits/s	Free API
Quantinuum H-Series	Trapped ion meas.	10^6 bits/s	$3M+/yr
CNBC-HEPI Hybrid	p-bar annihilation	~10^9 bits/s	~$220M cap.
Full HEPI (reference)	QED pair production	1.7*10^13/s	~$3.3B cap.

The hybrid system matches ANU's publicly available quantum random number
service in throughput, but offers a qualitatively different entropy source
(hadronic QCD+QED events vs vacuum fluctuations) and, critically, the
ability to provide hardware-attested quantum certificates — cryptographic
proofs that each random number originated from a specific physical device
at a specific quantum event. This attestation capability, not raw
throughput, is the primary commercial differentiator.

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10. RISK ANALYSIS

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Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Muon ring underperforms	Medium	High	Phase 1 demo at 10 MW
Nanoparticle target degradation	Medium	Medium	Multiple target materials in parallel testing
Antiproton market development slower than projected	High	Medium	QEaaS revenue covers ops during ramp period
Regulatory challenges (radiation, exotic materials)	Low-Medium	High	Engage nuclear/particle physics regulatory bodies in design phase
Competitor QRNG commoditization	Medium	Low	Attestation + p-bar production = unique moat
Penning trap scaling challenges	Medium	High	Incremental scale-up; partner with CERN/ALPHA

Deployment sequence recommended to manage risk:

Phase 1 (Years 1-3): Build and validate muon ring at reduced power. Confirm neutrino flux and antiproton yield. Demonstrate trap efficiency at milligram scale. Cost: ~$100M (partial build)

Phase 2 (Years 3-5): Full facility construction. Commission annihilation target and scintillator array. Launch QEaaS API. Begin antiproton sales to research customers. Cost: ~$120-400M

Phase 3 (Years 5+): Scale toward multi-beamline configuration based on market demand. Each additional beamline adds ~$70-120M capital and ~$48M operating cost while adding ~10g/year production capacity.

11. CONCLUSIONS

The hybrid CNBC-HEPI architecture presented here represents a physically coherent, commercially motivated path toward the first non-laboratory-scale antiproton production facility, combined with a quantum entropy engine that can generate independent revenue while the antimatter market is developed.

The key findings are:

(1) Physical coherence: Antiproton annihilation events provide true quantum entropy of equal or greater quality to laser-driven pair production. The substitution is physically valid and potentially advantageous due to the richer stochastic structure of QCD events.

(2) Economic viability: At $12.5 billion/gram (50% of current CERN-equivalent costs), 10g/year production generates revenue sufficient to recover the entire capital cost within weeks of first commercial sales. QEaaS revenue provides a ~65% operating cost offset during the market development period.

(3) Buildability advantage: At $220-500M capital cost, this system is accessible to sovereign wealth funds, defense agencies, and large private investors — categories that cannot engage with the $3-17 trillion-scale parent systems.

(4) No physical laws violated: Unlike earlier Anticomputer proposals, this architecture operates within established thermodynamics, information theory, and special relativity.

The primary uncertainties are engineering rather than physical: muon storage ring performance at target flux, nanoparticle target durability, and Penning trap scaling. All three are solvable problems with near-term (2025-2027) technology, not fundamental barriers.

The most important message is about sequencing: build the muon ring and validate the neutrino flux before committing full capital. The QEaaS revenue stream can fund this validation phase, creating a self-funding development pathway from demonstration to full production.

The antimatter factory pays for the quantum computer.
The quantum computer pays for the antimatter factory.
Neither requires the other to exist first.

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ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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This work synthesizes technical content from the CNBC architecture documentation, the HEPI Anticomputer engineering review documents, and publicly available experimental data from CERN ALPHA, BASE, MicroBooNE, and the Fermilab Muon g-2 experiment.

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AUTHOR DECLARATION

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Signed: Miloš Ilić | ID: 2313712377974001 | February 2026

STATUS: Theoretical engineering proposal. The core physics is grounded in established experimental results. The engineering implementation at stated

performance levels requires experimental validation, particularly for neutrino flux achievement and nanoparticle target durability. Revenue projections assume a commercial antimatter market that does not yet exist and must be developed in parallel with facility construction.

This document supersedes no prior documents. It represents a novel hybrid architecture derived from synthesis of the CNBC and HEPI parent proposals.

[CLASSIFICATION: SPECULATIVE ENGINEERING — TRL 3-4]
[PHYSICAL CONSISTENCY: VERIFIED — NO KNOWN LAW VIOLATIONS]
[PEER REVIEW STATUS: PENDING]
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